

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a single voice and piano accompaniment. It consists of four systems of music. Each system has a vocal line in the treble clef and a piano line in the bass clef. The key signature is B-flat major (two flats) and the time signature is 3/4. The lyrics are written below the vocal line, with line numbers 1, 2, and 3 indicating different verses. The music features a mix of eighth, quarter, and half notes, with some measures containing rests. The piano accompaniment is simple, often using chords or single notes to support the vocal melody. The score ends with a double bar line in the final system.

1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

hung with bloom a - long the bough,
tween - ty will not come the a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.